

GETTING TOGETHER

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AMERICAN INDIAN LEADER INTERVIEWED

The following is an interview with Wankun New Winini (Vernon Bellecourt) the National Coordinator of the American Indian Movement (AIM). The interview was conducted in New York City by a GETTING TOGETHER correspondent on March 5, 1973, in the midst of the attention created by the Indian seizure of Wounded Knee, South Dakota.

Q: What is the American Indian Movement?

A: The American Indian Movement formed in Minneapolis, Minnesota, in mid-1968. We're in the reservations. We have some 60 chapters now. The growth is phenomenal. On the Wounded Knee issue, we have organizations forming all over the country. We encompass all the way from our elder spiritual leaders, to our traditionalists, to our young people, to conservatives, to our so-called sell-outs. They're all with us. We have the support of 85 to 90 percent of the Indian people in this country. It's just a handful of bureaucrats who have become the white man's kind of Indian versus the Indian — they're the ones who condemn us. But we are advocates of all Indians who are advocates of our people.

Since the American Indian Movement, we have had to deal with very controversial issues. Actually, it shouldn't even be controversial. We're just standing up and asking for justice to be served to us the same way it is served to other people. We, being the sovereign people, should certainly be protected under the Constitution of the United States.

We have situations where we've had Indian men charged with first degree murder, for murder on circumstantial evidence, held without bonds, contrary to the 8th amendment of this constitution. We've had excessive bonds posted. We've had illegal search and seizure. Our rights are completely violated, and this does not come to the attention unless we stand and oppose it. On the other hand, we've had white people accused or arrested for murdering Indian people, and they've been charged with 2nd, 3rd degree manslaughter. . . .

You can understand the history of this country that still allows its children and encourages them to play cowboys and Indians — cowboys always winning and then growing up watching cowboys and Indians in the movies and cowboys always winning and Indians are always discredited and portrayed as subhuman people and this going on in the movies and literature in schools. We find ingrained is racism, and as if the people don't know it exists. But it all surfaces in a situation like that. But in Custer, South Dakota, police officials overreacted and assaulted us. Of course, we assaulted them; and in fact, we knocked the hell out of them. There was an overwhelming victory for Indian people in this country. . . . We were able to deal with Custer again in 1973. Now, there was a little property damage. The whole nation was

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Thousands of Mothers Protest

Elimination of Child Care Centers



Chinese families protesting Nixon's cutbacks

Nixon's plan to eliminate child-care services for tens of thousands of working mothers throughout the country has provoked wide resistance. The following are reports of two of the major protest demonstrations held recently. The articles were submitted by GETTING TOGETHER reporters in New York City and San Francisco.

NEW YORK CITY — On Tuesday, March 6, at Federal Plaza in New York City, over 1,000 Black, Latin, Asian, and white working and welfare mothers and their children united to protest Federal government plans to cut off day care services to 34,000 working mothers in NYC. Working mothers will be cut-off from day care services through a new regulation of the Department of Health, Education, and Welfare, which terminates Federal support for social services to working mothers who earn salaries more than one-third higher than their state's official poverty level. (New York: \$5400)

The real motive for this regulation is the government's attempt to lay off workers and re-employ them for half the pay as is happening already in the Public Works Program (PWP). The PWP puts war veterans and childless men and women to work in the post offices, hospitals, and welfare offices, and pays them an average of .90 - 1.20/hr., far less than the regular workers.

"WORK FARE" PLAN

The government's plan for welfare mothers is the "work fare" plan, which forces them to work for their welfare checks. But in order for the welfare mothers to go to work, the city will have to provide day care services for their children. So the city must eliminate child care for working mothers in order to provide it for the cheap labor pool of welfare mothers.

Welfare mothers will be employed in city jobs and will be non-unionized, receiving no benefits. They will not only be used as a cheap labor pool but also as a scab labor pool to break up unions.

W.I.N.

Another program that will need the

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S.F. Chinatown

International Women's Day Celebration

by
a Staff Reporter

On Thursday, March 8th over 300 people attended the Chinese Progressive Association Celebration of International Women's Day. The program consisted of a community dinner, a skit on the exploitation of Women Garment workers, an historical slide show by student women, 3 folk songs sung by a mother, a song and dance routine called the "Flower Drum Dance" performed by two students and a mother of three, and ended with the showing of *Red Detachment of Women*.

For the past few weeks, women from both the campus and community, foreign born and American born — young and old — worked together to put on this significant event. A mother of 9 children commented on how successful the celebration was, because it not only gave her the opportunity "to work and get to know students", but also because the program was "such a hit" in spite of the fact that most of the community women had to work full-time and could only "come together to rehearse two times."

HUSBAND COMMENTS

A husband of one of the performers stated that he enjoyed watching his wife perform. He said he could also strongly identify with the garment women's skit because his wife "has to work under those same kind of oppressive conditions." Overall he felt with the help of the slides that "it was both educational and spirit-lifting."

A student woman was elated to see so

many progressive men and women come out for the event even on a weekday night. She said, "This is my first experience working in the community — it's really exciting." A newly arrived immigrant housewife and mother found it most educational that even here in "Golden Mountain women must still struggle to overcome feudal oppression in the home and on the job." Her husband, who works for a big corporation, added, "liberation of women is only part of a bigger struggle, in the liberation of all oppressed people."

LIBERATION

In all, the event successfully brought continued on pg. 3



Opening scene of the San Francisco Chinatown International Women's Day Celebration on March 8